

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ J 9 6
 ♥ J 9 2
 ♦ Q J 10
 ♣ 10 9 3 2

♠ A Q 3

♥ 6 3

♦ A K 5 4

♣ A Q 6 5



♠ K 10 8 2

♥ K 10 4

♦ 8 7 2

♣ K J 7

♠ 7 5 4

♥ A Q 8 7 5

♦ 9 6 3

♣ 8 4

West	North	East	South
			Pass
Pass	1♦	Pass	1♥
Pass	2NT	Pass	3NT
All Pass			
3NT by North			

North is to play 3NT. East leads the ♠2. West puts on the ♠J.

Winners: ♠=2 ♥=1 ♦=2 ♣=1 Total = 6

You need three more winners. It is possible your fourth ♦ can be established, but that needs a 3-3 split. It's also possible that the ♣ finesse will work, and also the ♥ finesse. Since you need the ♥ finesse anyway you should go ahead and try to establish the ♥s.

Win the first trick with your ♠Q and play a low ♥, ducking in dummy. West will no doubt win a cheap trick but no matter. When you next gain the lead play your other low ♥ and finesse the ♥Q. Assume this wins (if it doesn't you will be going down for sure). Play the ♥A and if both defenders follow your other 2 ♥s are good and your contract is made.

Ducking the first ♥ and finessing the second could let you wind up with no tricks at all in the ♥ suit.

But, it is your only chance to make the contract.

Board 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 8 6 5 3
 ♥ K 5 4
 ♦ K J 10 8 5
 ♣ Q

♠ A 9 2
 ♥ J 7 3
 ♦ A 9 2
 ♣ J 9 6 5



♠ 7 4
 ♥ A Q 8 6 2
 ♦ Q 6
 ♣ A 8 4 3

♠ K Q J 10
 ♥ 10 9
 ♦ 7 4 3
 ♣ K 10 7 2

West	North	East	South
3♥	Pass	1♥	Pass
All Pass		4♥	

4♥ by East
 dummy's ♥K.

Some pretty aggressive bidding gets you to a challenging game. East is to play 4♥. South leads the ♠K, overtaken by North's ♠A. North returns a ♠ to South's ♠10, and he then plays the ♠Q.

Losers: ♠=2 ♥=0 ♦=1 ♣=3 Total = 6

With 2 tricks already gone you still have 4 losers. You could consider ruffing the 3 ♣ losers in dummy but that would just create a trump loser even when trumps are splitting 3-2. So it looks like you will have to establish the ♦ suit for discards. You could pull trumps and then play your ♦Q, hoping the defenders will grab their ♦A immediately. But unless they are real novices they will hold it up one round and you'll no longer be able to reach dummy.

The solution is to establish the ♦s before you use up

Ruff the third ♠, then play ♦Q, (which they will duck), and another ♦, (which they will probably take). Win whatever they return, pull trumps ending in dummy, and enjoy your 3 ♦ winners.

If North does not take the second ♦ you continue the suit, and whether you ruff or discard a loser you still make the contract.